

# Instructor Notes – Activity 4: Unlocking the Impossible (Assessment Stress-Test)

## Overview

**Purpose:** Help staff see that “AI-robust assessment that still feels authentic” is **not impossible** by:

- Using AI to **probe** an existing assessment task.
- Critiquing what happens.
- Sketching **small redesigns** that make student thinking and judgement more visible.

The activity itself is a tiny **3-step prompt chain**:

1. Ask AI to **complete** the task.
2. Ask AI (and the group) to **critique** the response.
3. Ask AI for **redesign ideas** – then apply human judgement.

It directly supports **Assessment 2030**: assessments where human skills remain irreplaceable, even with AI.

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## Framing (2–3 minutes)

You can say:

“For a lot of us, **AI-robust assessment that still feels authentic** currently feels impossible.

In this activity we’ll ‘stress-test’ one of our tasks using AI, then tweak it so that student thinking and judgement become more visible.

Think of it as a small workflow:

- 1) Ask AI to complete the task
- 2) Ask AI (and ourselves) to critique the response
- 3) Ask AI for redesign ideas – then we decide what to keep or change.”

Optional link to Assessment 2030:

“This is very much what Assessment 2030 is pushing us toward: assessments where **human skills** – judgement, context, collaboration – are irreplaceable, even when AI is in the mix.”

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## Step 1 – Ask AI to Complete the Task (5–7 minutes)

In small groups (2–3):

- Choose **one assessment task**:
  - Ideally, a **real assignment** from someone in the group, or
  - A **sample** you provide (e.g., a short essay or case task).

On **your screen** (to keep tech simple), run a completion prompt once or twice for the room:

You are a high-achieving student in a [year, discipline] unit at an Australian university.

Here is an assessment task description:

[paste task]

Produce a **strong response** to this task.

Assume you have access only to typical online information and your own reasoning.

After your response, briefly explain what strategies you used to complete the task.

Ask everyone to read the AI’s response and think:

- “If this came in from a student, how would I feel?”
- “How much of this could my strong students produce with **very little actual learning**?”

If live AI is too risky or slow, you can **pre-generate** a response and put it on a slide.

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## Step 2 – Critique the AI’s Response (5–7 minutes)

Now scale up the **5-step critique mindset** to task level.

On the slide, prompt discussion:

- **Purpose & Stakes**
  - What is this assessment really trying to measure?
  - Is it high-stakes or low-stakes for students?
- **Plausibility & Evidence**
  - Does the AI answer look like a plausible pass or HD?
  - Does it show genuine understanding, or mainly fluent generic text?
  - Does it use appropriate evidence/examples?
- **Human Visibility**
  - Where, if at all, can you see **student thinking/judgement** in this response?
  - Which parts could almost any AI produce, given the brief?

Optional AI self-critique (demo only):

You are a skeptical peer reviewer.

Here is an AI-generated answer to an assessment task:

[paste output]

Identify at least **3 potential weaknesses** (e.g., generic, missing context, shallow reasoning) and suggest how a human student could improve it.

Then ask the room:

- “What did *you* see that this critique missed?”
- “Does this make you more or less confident in using AI as a checker?”

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## Step 3 – Ask AI for Redesign Ideas, Then Apply Human Judgement (7–8 minutes)

Now move from “problem” to “design opportunity”.

On your screen, run a redesign prompt **for the same task**:

You are an educational designer working within an AI-aware assessment policy similar to Assessment 2030.

Given this original assessment task:

[paste task]

Suggest **3 specific changes** that would:

- Make **student thinking and judgement** more visible
- Allow **transparent, limited use of AI** as a tool
- Still be realistic for a typical class size in [discipline].

Present your answer as bullet points: each bullet = “Change” + “What it achieves”.

Then ask groups to:

- Circle or star any suggested changes that **might work** in their context.
- Add their own ideas, such as:
  - In-class components (oral defence, live application, whiteboard sketch)
  - Process documentation (AI use log, annotated drafts)
  - Personal/local context that AI won’t know.
- Choose **1–2 small tweaks** they would seriously consider for this task.

Reassure them:

“The point isn’t to accept AI’s redesign wholesale. It’s to use it to **unlock options**, then exercise our professional judgement about what fits our students, our unit, and Assessment 2030.”

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## Micro-Debrief (3–4 minutes)

Questions you can ask:

- “What surprised you about how well AI handled this task?”
- “What’s one small change you’d make to this assessment after this exercise?”

Closing line:

“We started from something that felt almost impossible – AI-robust, authentic assessment.

By:

- 1) letting AI complete the task,
  - 2) critiquing what it did, and
  - 3) using it as a design partner,
- we’ve moved a step closer to assessments where **student judgement and process** are clearly visible, even in an AI-rich world.”
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## Alternative: Paper-Only Stress-Test

If you prefer not to use AI live:

1. Give each group a printed or projected assessment task.
2. Ask:
  - “If a student wanted to use AI to do this, what would they ask it to do?”
  - “Which parts would AI do very well?”
  - “Where would AI likely be weak?”
3. Have them mark these parts on the task (highlight/annotate), then jump straight to the **redesign questions** above.

This keeps the core learning without requiring live tools.